

JORDAN RIVERA

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SKILLS

Languages :: Java 21, Kotlin, Groovy, Python
Document & Print :: PDFBox, Apache POI (DOCX/XLSX), iText, PostScript
Layout engines :: Custom DSL design, semantic layout trees, pagination, snapshot testing
Build & infrastructure :: Maven, Gradle, GitHub Actions, JitPack
Testing :: JUnit 5, AssertJ, PDFBox-based PNG diff, layout-graph snapshots
Distribution :: Maven Central, Sonatype OSSRH, GPG signing, JitPack

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science - University of Manchester | 2021. Distinction. Thesis: Composable layout primitives for deterministic document rendering.
BSc Software Engineering - Imperial College London | 2019. First-class honours. Specialisation in compilers and static analysis.
Oracle Java Certification - Professional track | 2023. Java 17 platform deep-dive: records, sealed types, pattern matching, virtual threads.

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Spanish (Basic)
Work Eligibility: Eligible to work in the UK and the EU
Open Source: Maintainer of GraphCompose. Regular contributor to PDFBox issue triage.
Speaking: JVM Summit 2024, Devovx UK 2025 — both on declarative document layout.

PROFILE

Platform engineer with 10+ years building resilient document-generation pipelines, layout engines, and developer-facing template systems. Specialised in high-throughput PDF rendering, semantic authoring DSLs, and turning brittle production-ops scripts into typed, snapshot-tested libraries that scale.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer, Northwind Systems | 2024-Present - Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across 8 product teams. Reduced template maintenance time by 70% by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.
Software Engineer, BrightLeaf Labs | 2021-2024 - Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing 2M+ documents per month. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.

SELECTED PROJECTS

GraphCompose (Java 21, PDFBox, Maven, JMH) - Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)
Template Studio (Kotlin, Compose Desktop, PDFBox PNG diff) - Internal tool for evaluating CV, proposal, and invoice output across 14 design presets. PNG diffing, side-by-side layout, baseline freezing.
LayoutLint (Java 21, JavaParser, Spoon) - Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.
ChromeForge (Java, GraphCompose, Pandoc bridge) - Editorial-magazine document toolkit built on GraphCompose: cinematic covers, pull quotes, multi-column flow, sidebar callouts.